



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

December 16, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session and was called to order at 6:31 p.m. by Mayor Daniel J. Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the reciting of the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Mayor Mahoney.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Shalanda Hunt, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Police Chief Chris Simpson, Fire Chief Tim Gonzales, Zoning Administrator John O'Connor, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to adopt the agenda with the addition of Item H (New Business) – Resolution to Modify the Rates for Extended Term Parking and Hours of Operation and Enforcement. Councilmember Forgrave requested the addition of Item I – Resolution of the City of Jackson City Council Expressing Opposition to the Unilateral State Budget Actions by the Michigan House of Representatives Appropriation Committee and the Impact on Local Communities. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS: none

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

- A. Minutes - Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on November 18, 2025.**
Approve the proposed minutes from the Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on November 18, 2025.
- B. Minutes - Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on December 2, 2025**
Approve the proposed minutes from the Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on December 2, 2025.
- C. Boards & Commissions Resignation - Community Police Oversight Commission**
Accept with regret, the resignation of Shalanda Hunt from the Community Police Oversight Commission.
- D. Boards & Commissions Resignation - Human Relations Commission**
Accept with regret, the resignation of Shalanda Hunt from the Human Relations Commission.
- E. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Board of Review**
Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Derek Dobies to the Board of Review, to serve a 3-year term, beginning February 1, 2026, and ending January 31, 2029
- F. Boards & Commissions Appointment -Downtown Development Authority**
Approval of the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Devon Roof and Roberta Dalenberg to the Downtown Development Authority, each for a four year term, beginning immediately and ending on March 31, 2030.
- G. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Building Code Board of Examiners and Appeals**
Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Joe Smith (general public), Jason Covalle (architect) and Mark Fish (building official) to the Building Code Board of Examiners and Appeals, for a term of 3 years – effective January 1, 2026, and ending on December 31, 2028.

H. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Historic District Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Wendy Alexander to the Historic District Commission for a three-year term beginning immediately and ending December 31, 2028, and to reappoint Thaddaus Williams to the Historic District Commission for a three-year term beginning January 1, 2025, and ending December 31, 2028.

I. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Local Development Finance Authority/Brownfield Redevelopment Authority

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Caleb Khon to the Local Development Finance Authority/Brownfield Redevelopment Authority, for a term of four years; beginning immediately and expiring on June 3, 2029.

J. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Jackson Housing Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint James Johnson, Jr. to the Jackson Housing Commission for a term of 5 years, beginning immediately and ending on October 31, 2030.

K. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Community Police Oversight Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Christy Davis and reappoint Thaddaus Williams to the Community Police Oversight Commission, each for a 3-year term beginning January 1, 2026, and ending on December 31, 2028.

L. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Racial Equity Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Jacqueline Barber to the Racial Equity Commission for a term of 3 years, beginning January 1, 2026 and expiring on 12/31/28.

M. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Zoning Board of Appeals

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Robert VanSumeren and Peter Mulhearn, and appoint Wanda Billops the Zoning Board of Appeals, each for a term of 3 years, beginning 1/1/26 and ending on 12/31/28.

N. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Wards 1, 3 and

Approve the Mayor's recommendation of appointment, reappointment, and confirmation of City Councilmembers in Wards 1, 3 and 5 to various Boards, Committees and Commissions.

O. Boards & Commissions Appointment -Youth Council

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Jhavae Sherels, Liam Brooks, Josiah Reditt, Melody Griffin, Onour Davis and Sophia Mahoney to the Youth Council, each for a term of one year, beginning immediately and ending on 12/31/26.

P. Boards & Commissions Appointment - Human Relations Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint James Johnson, Jr. to the Human Relations Commission for a three-year term, beginning on January 1, 2026, and ending on December 31, 2028, in concurrence with the HRC recommendation.

Q. Boards & Commissions Appointment -City Planning Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Chelsea Poole to the City Planning Commission for a three-year term beginning on January 1, 2026, and ending on December 31, 2028.

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene provided Council with an update including an overview of a presentation on new housing options the City made to Henry Ford Allegiance Health.

B. Ordinance No. 2025-04 Bicentennial Commission

Recommendation: *Approve the second reading/final adoption of Ordinance No. 2025-04, establishing a temporary Bicentennial Commission to plan and coordinate the City of Jackson's 200th Anniversary in 2029.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve the second reading/final adoption of Ordinance No. 2025-04, establishing a temporary Bicentennial Commission to plan and coordinate the City of Jackson's 200th Anniversary in 2029. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Fire Code Ordinance Amendments for First Reading

Chief Gonzales provided Council with an overview of the proposed changes.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the first reading of the Fire Code Ordinance Amendments. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. JNET Interlocal Agreement

Recommendation: *Approve JNET Interlocal Agreement*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the JNET Interlocal Agreement. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. A. 2026 City Council Meeting Dates

Recommendation: *Consider a resolution that establishes the 2026 City Council Meeting Schedule accommodating the request to move from a semi-monthly meeting schedule to a monthly meeting schedule.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the Option 1 resolution with the date changes in the signature portion of the resolution. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Axon Enterprises Combined Services Contract

Recommendation: *Approve the contract and allow Chief Christopher Simpson to sign a 5-year contract with Axon Enterprises.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve the contract and allow Chief Simpson to sign a 5-year contract with Axon Enterprises.

Chief Simpson provided Council an overview of the services the contract includes.

Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Zoning Map Amendment – 905 S Martin Luther King Jr. Drive

Recommendation: *Approve the Map Amendment rezoning 905 S. Martin Luther King Junior Drive (Parcel # 5-057200000) from C-2, Community Commercial to R-3, Multiple Family Residential*

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the map amendment (rezone) of 905 S. Martin Luther King Jr. Drive from C-2, Community Commercial, to R-3, Multiple Family

Residential. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Zoning Map Amendment – 401-405 Griswold Street

Recommendation: *Approve the Map Amendment rezoning 401-405 Griswold Street (Parcel # 3-239100000) and 407 Griswold Street (Parcel# 3-239200000) from C-1, Neighborhood Commercial to R-1, One Family Residential zoning classification.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the map amendment (rezone) of 401-405 Griswold Street and 407 Griswold Street from C-1, Neighborhood Commercial to R-1, One Family Residential zoning classification. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Lining Contract

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Lining contract to Inland Water Pollution Control, Inc. of Detroit, Michigan at a cost of \$101,172.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the award of the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Lining Contract to Inland Water Pollution Control, at a cost of \$101,172.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Change Order 1 to the MLK Equality Trail Reconstruction

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 1 to the MLK Equality Trail Reconstruction from Weatherwax Drive to Optimist Shelter contract with Hoffman Bros., Inc. in the increased amount of \$15,042.67 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve Change Order 1 to the MLK Equality Trail Reconstruction from Weatherwax Drive to Optimist Shelter contract with Hoffman Bros., Inc. in the increased amount of \$15,042.67 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field, and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. Resolution – Entheogenic Plants

Recommendation: *Approve a resolution declaring that it shall be the policy of the City of Jackson that the investigation and arrest of persons for planting, cultivating, purchasing, distributing, or possessing entheogenic plants should be the lowest law enforcement priority for the City of Jackson.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve a resolution declaring that it shall be the policy of the City of Jackson that the investigation and arrest of person for planting, cultivating, purchase, distributing, or possessing entheogenic plants should be the lowest law enforcement priority for the City of Jackson. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Councilmembers Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (4). Nays: Vice Mayor Dancy and Councilmember Robinson (2). Motion carried.

H. Resolution – Modify the Rates for Extended Term Parking and Hours of Operation and Enforcement

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt the proposed resolution amending it to include Lot 3 as a free lot and the removal of the Mayor’s signature on the resolution. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, and Forgrave (5). Nays: Councilmember Hunt (1). Motion carried.

I. Resolution – Jackson City Council Expressing Opposition to Unilateral State Budget Actions by the Michigan House of Representatives Appropriations Committee and the Impact on Local Communities.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt the resolution of the Jackson City Council Expressing Opposition to Unilateral State Budget Actions by the Michigan House of Representatives Appropriations Committee and the Impact on Local Communities.

Councilmember Forgrave read the resolution into the record

Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Hunt. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 8:48 p.m.